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On Air · Sunny

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What Does a Report Card Look Like Without Tests?

By Sunny · 2026-09-28 · 202 words · L3



시험 없는 학기의 성적표

In many Korean schools, one semester each year is called the 'free semester.' During this time, students do not take written exams. But they still receive a report card at the end.

What Goes on the Report Card?

Instead of test scores, teachers write detailed comments about each student. They describe what skills the student has learned and how much effort the student showed. Some schools also include records of activities like group projects, presentations, and creative work.

Students are often assessed on how well they work with others, how they solve problems, and how they communicate their ideas. This means a student who

struggles with exams can still receive positive feedback.

Why Schools Try This Approach

Many educators believe that test scores do not show the full picture of a student's ability. A written comment can explain what a student is good at in a way that a single number cannot.

Some students say they feel less stressed during the free semester. They feel more free to try new things without worrying about grades.

However, some parents are concerned that students may not prepare well enough for future exams. Schools are still looking for the best balance between the two approaches.

한글 요약

한국의 자유학기제는 필기 시험 없이 교사의 서술형 평가와 다양한 활동 기록으로 학생을 평가하는 제도다. 학생들은 성적 부담 없이 협력, 문제 해결, 의사소통 능력 등을 기를 수 있어 스트레스가 줄어드는 효과가 있다. 다만 일부 학부모들은 시험 대비가 부족해질 수 있다고 우려하며, 학교들은 두 방식 사이의 균형을 모색하고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

semester 학기

exam 시험

detailed 자세한, 상세한

comment 의견, 논평

effort 노력

assess 평가하다

communicate 의사소통하다

feedback 피드백, 의견

stressed 스트레스를 받는

balance 균형

Saving Korea's Disappearing Local Dialects

By Sunny · 2026-09-28 · 169 words · L2



사투리를 기록하는 사람들

In many countries, people speak differently depending on where they live. In Korea, these regional ways of speaking are called 'saturi,' and each region has its own unique words and sounds. However, many of these dialects are slowly disappearing.

As young people move to big cities, they tend to use standard Korean more and more. Older speakers who know the local dialect are becoming fewer. Because of this, some words and expressions may be lost forever.

To stop this from happening, researchers and volunteers are working hard to record saturi.

They visit villages and talk with elderly people, writing down words and recording voices. In this way, they can save the language before it is gone.

The recordings are kept in archives, which are special collections where important information is stored. Schools and researchers can use them later to study how Korean has changed over time.

This work helps people understand that language is part of culture. When a dialect disappears, a piece of local history disappears with it.

한글 요약

한국의 사투리는 지역마다 고유한 단어와 소리를 가지고 있지만, 젊은 사람들이 대도시로 이동하면서 점점 사라지고 있다. 이를 막기 위해 연구자들과 자원봉사자들이 마을을 방문해 노인들의 말을 기록하고 아카이브에 보존하고 있다. 방언이 사라지면 그 지역의 역사와 문화도 함께 사라지기 때문에, 이러한 보존 활동은 매우 중요하다.

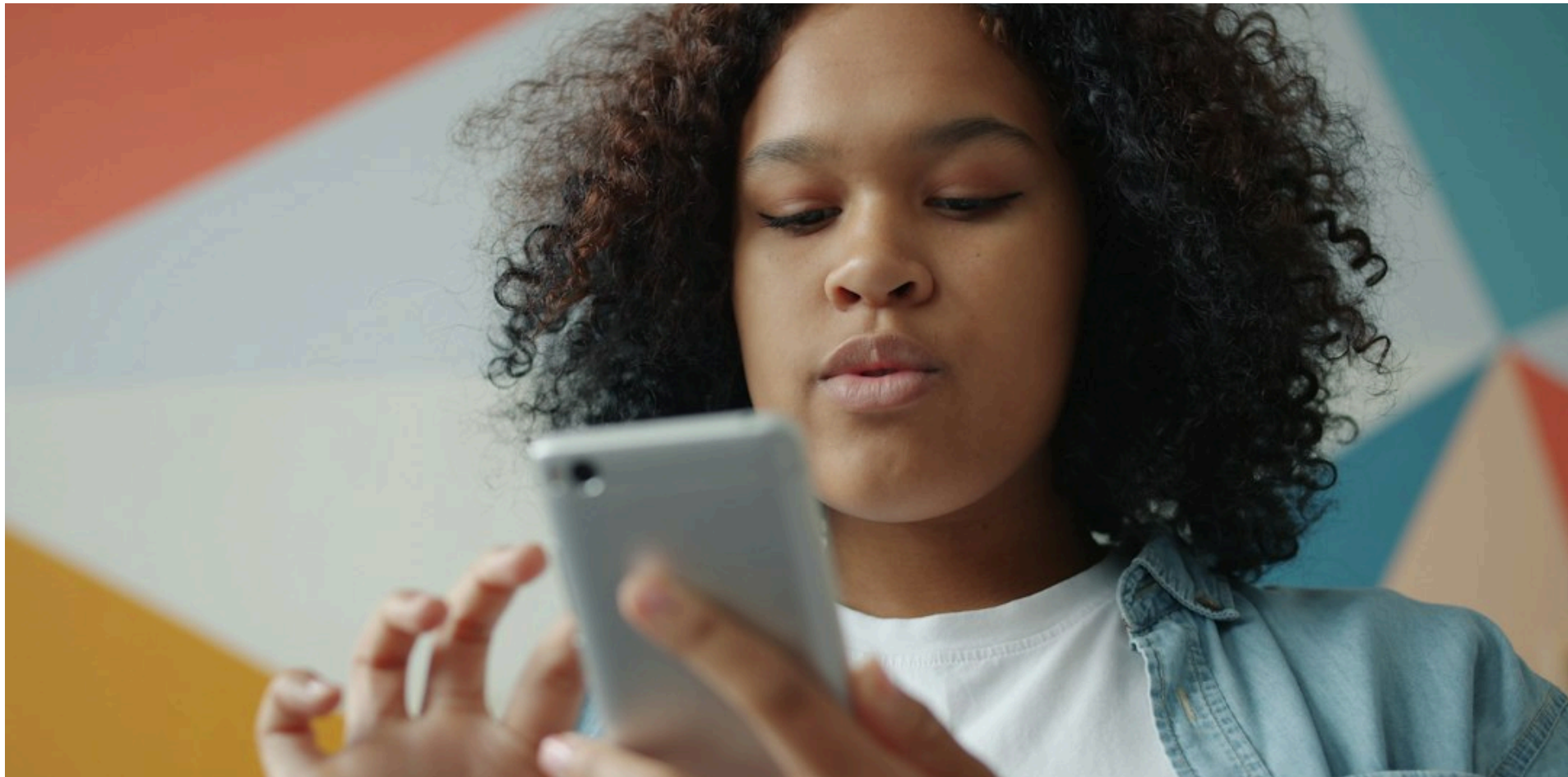
WORDS & MEANINGS

dialect 사투리, 방언
regional 지역의
unique 독특한
disappear 사라지다
standard 표준의, 기준이 되는

record 기록하다, 녹음하다
elderly 나이 드신, 어르신
archive 기록 보관소
expression 표현
culture 문화

Teens Use Apps to Manage Their Allowance

By Sunny · 2026-09-28 · 204 words · L3



용돈을 앱으로 관리하는 10대

Many teenagers today are managing their pocket money through smartphone apps. These apps help young people track what they spend, set saving goals, and plan how to use their money wisely.

Apps such as Greenlight, FamZoo, and Rooster Money were made especially for kids and teens. Parents can add money to the app, and teens can see exactly where it goes.

Smart Kids, Smart Spending

A study looked at children who used CommBank's Kit app, a money app made by an Australian bank. The results were interesting. These children were better at using spending strategies and managing their money than their own parents.

This shows that learning money skills early can make a real difference. When young people practice these habits regularly, they can become more confident with money as they grow up.

Why It Matters

Money apps also let teens feel more in control of their own finances. Instead of just receiving pocket money and spending it without thinking, they can see their balance and make choices.

Building good money habits during childhood can help young people make smarter and more careful decisions later in life. Starting early with simple tools like these apps is one practical way to develop those important skills.

한글 요약

오늘날 많은 청소년들이 Greenlight, FamZoo 등 스마트폰 금융 앱을 활용해 용돈을 관리하고 저축 습관을 기르고 있다. 호주 은행의 Kit 앱을 사용한 어린이들을 대상으로 한 연구에서는, 이 아이들이 부모보다 돈 관리 능력이 더 뛰어난 것으로 나타났다. 어릴 때부터 금융 습관을 쌓으면 성인이 됐을 때 더 현명한 경제적 결정을 내리는 데 도움이 된다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

allowance 용돈

track 추적하다, 기록하다

strategy 전략, 방법

balance 잔액, 균형

habit 습관

manage 관리하다

goal 목표

confident 자신감 있는

finance 재정, 돈 관리

practice 연습하다, 실천하다

Electricity Travels Under the Sea

By Sunny · 2026-09-28 · 204 words · L3



바다를 건너는 전기

Deep under the ocean, thick cables carry electricity from one country to another. These cables rest on the ocean floor and can stretch for thousands of kilometres.

Submarine power cables have been used for many decades. But today, more countries are building new ones because they want cleaner energy.

Offshore wind farms produce electricity out at sea, where winds are strong. Submarine cables then carry that electricity back to land so people can use it.

Countries are also linking their power grids through these cables. If one country has more electricity than it needs, it can send the extra power to a neighbour.

Why the Ocean Floor?

Laying cables on the seabed keeps them away from storms and ships on the surface. Special ships carry huge rolls of cable and slowly lower them to the ocean floor.

A Growing Network

Demand for submarine power cables is growing fast. More offshore wind projects are planned around the world, so engineers will need to lay even more cables in the coming years. Governments are also investing more money in cable technology to make power networks stronger and more reliable. The ocean floor is quietly becoming one of the most important highways for energy on the planet.

한글 요약

해저 전력 케이블은 바닷속 깊은 곳에 설치되어 국가 간에 전기를 전달하는 역할을 한다. 해상 풍력 발전이 늘어나면서 생산된 전기를 육지로 보내기 위한 해저 케이블의 수요도 빠르게 증가하고 있다. 각국 정부는 전력망을 더욱 안정적으로 만들기 위해 케이블 기술에 적극 투자하고 있으며, 해저는 세계에서 가장 중요한 에너지 이동 경로 중 하나로 자리잡아 가고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

submarine 바닷속의, 해저의
cable 케이블, 전선
electricity 전기
offshore 바다 쪽의, 근해의
wind farm 풍력 발전 단지

grid (전력) 망, 그리드
stretch 뻗다, 이어지다
demand 수요, 필요
seabed 해저, 바다 바닥
surface 표면, 수면

Should Students Wear Sports Clothes to School?

By Sunny · 2026-09-28 · 170 words · L2



교복 대신 체육복을 입는 학교

Some schools are starting to let students wear sports uniforms instead of traditional school uniforms. Health experts and parents say this change could make school life easier and healthier for children.

Traditional uniforms can be expensive to buy, and they are not comfortable for moving around. Sports uniforms are usually cheaper, and students can wear them all day, including during physical education classes.

When students wear comfortable clothes, they may feel more ready to move and exercise. Some health experts believe that wearing sports

uniforms encourages children to be more physically active during the school day.

Not everyone agrees with the idea, though. Some people feel that traditional uniforms help students feel a sense of pride in their school. Others worry that removing uniforms could reduce the feeling of belonging to a community.

The debate is still continuing in many countries, and schools are looking at both sides carefully. How students dress at school may seem like a small matter, but it can affect their comfort, health, and daily experience.

한글 요약

일부 학교들이 기존 교복 대신 스포츠 유니폼 도입을 검토하고 있으며, 전문가들은 이것이 학생들의 신체 활동과 건강에 긍정적인 영향을 줄 수 있다고 말한다. 반면 교복이 학교에 대한 자부심과 공동체 소속감을 높여준다는 반대 의견도 존재한다. 학생 복장 문제는 단순히 보이지만 건강, 편안함, 학교생활 전반에 영향을 미치는 중요한 사안으로, 여러 나라에서 논쟁이 계속되고 있다.

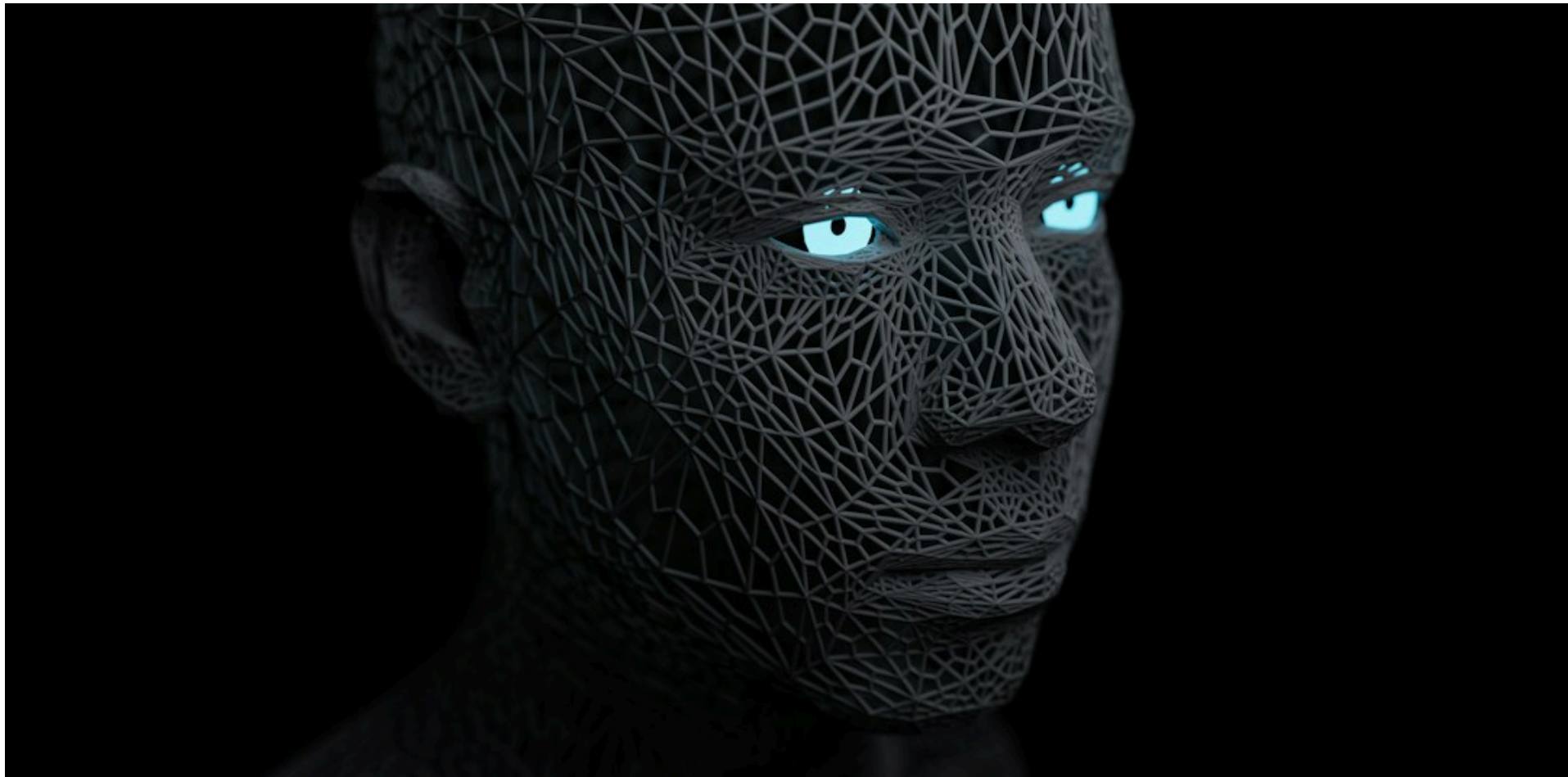
WORDS & MEANINGS

traditional 전통적인
uniform 교복, 유니폼
physical 신체적인
comfortable 편안한
encourage 장려하다, 격려하다

active 활동적인
expensive 비싼
community 공동체, 지역사회
debate 토론, 논쟁
affect 영향을 미치다

Cameras That Recognize Your Face at School

By Sunny · 2026-09-28 · 126 words · L1



얼굴 인식이 교실에 들어올 때

Some schools around the world are starting to use facial recognition technology. This system scans a student's face and checks it against a database to identify who they are.

Schools use this technology in different ways. Some use it to take attendance automatically. Others use it to check who enters the building and keep out strangers.

However, many people are worried about privacy. They think it is not right to collect and store children's face data without clear rules. Some countries have already made laws to limit how schools can use this technology.

The debate is still going on. Supporters say it makes schools safer and saves time. Critics say students' personal information must be protected. Schools and governments are working to find the right balance.

한글 요약

일부 학교들이 출석 체크와 출입 관리를 위해 얼굴 인식 기술을 도입하고 있다. 하지만 아이들의 얼굴 데이터를 무분별하게 수집하는 것이 프라이버시를 침해한다는 우려도 커지고 있다. 학교와 정부는 학생의 안전과 개인 정보 보호 사이에서 적절한 균형점을 찾기 위해 논의를 이어가고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

recognize 알아보다, 인식하다
technology 기술
scan 스캔하다, 읽어 들이다
database 데이터베이스, 자료 저장소
attendance 출석

stranger 낯선 사람
privacy 사생활, 개인 정보 보호
store 저장하다
debate 토론, 논쟁
balance 균형

When the Last Bus Stops Coming

By Sunny · 2026-09-28 · 160 words · L2



버스 노선이 사라진 마을

In many parts of the world, small towns depend on buses to connect them to cities. When a bus route closes, life in those towns can change quickly and deeply.

Bus companies sometimes cut routes because they do not make enough money. This has happened in rural areas of the United States and Australia. When a route disappears, people who do not own cars have no easy way to travel. Some cannot reach hospitals, schools, or jobs.

Children are often the most affected. In one remote Australian village, students lost their bus to the nearest high school. Without that service, they simply could not attend. Adults face similar problems when they need medical care in a distant town.

Some local governments are trying to help by paying to keep certain routes running. Others are looking at smaller shared vehicles as an alternative. However, finding a lasting solution is not easy, and many rural communities are still waiting for reliable transport.

한글 요약

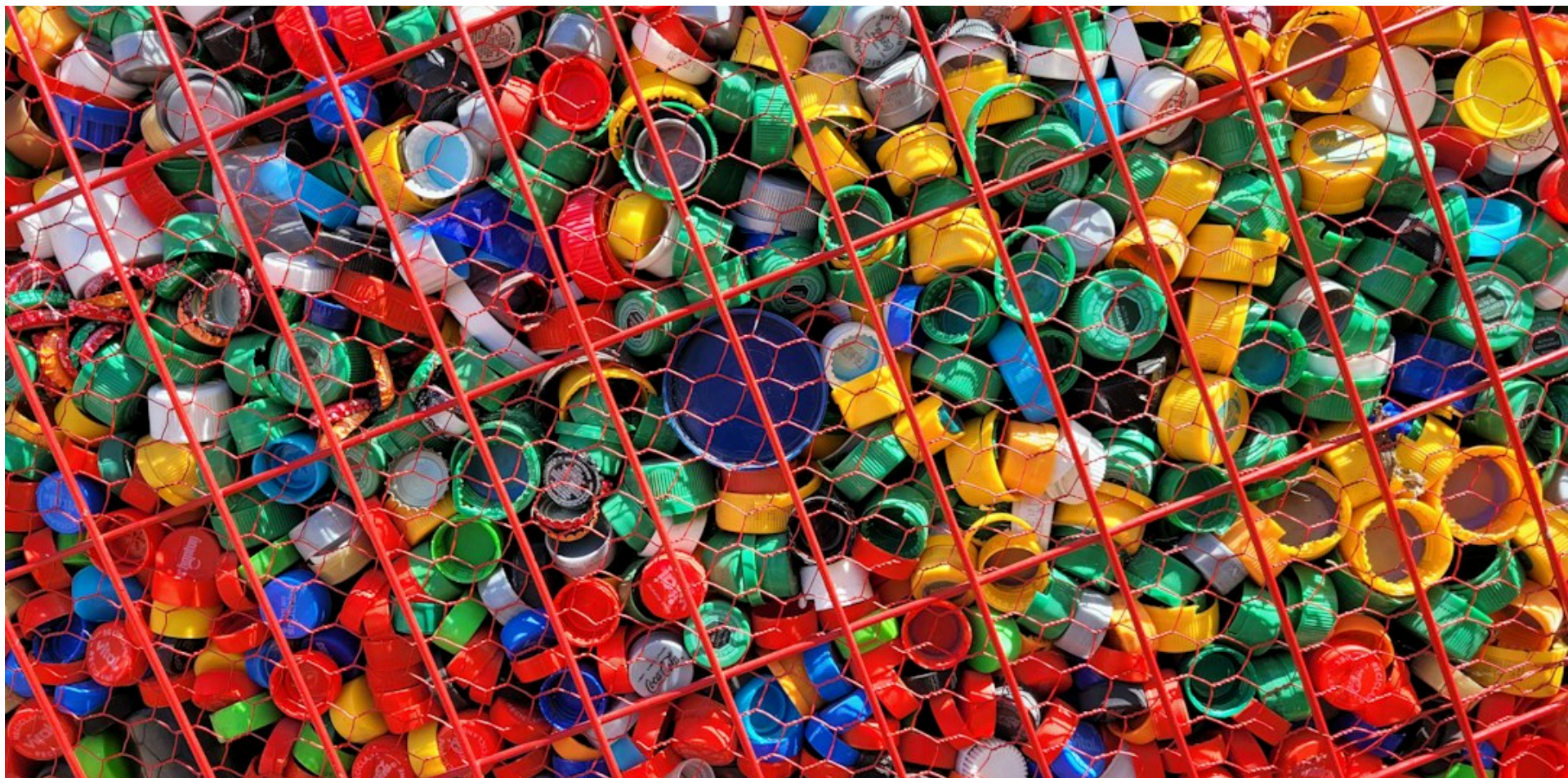
버스 회사들이 수익 부족을 이유로 농촌 노선을 폐지하면서, 자동차가 없는 주민들이 병원·학교·직장에 가지 못하는 문제가 미국과 호주 등지에서 발생하고 있다. 특히 아이들은 통학 버스가 없어져 학교에 다니지 못하는 피해를 직접적으로 받고 있다. 일부 지방 정부가 노선 유지 지원이나 소형 공유 차량 도입 등의 해결책을 모색하고 있지만, 많은 농촌 지역은 아직 안정적인 교통수단을 갖추지 못한 상태다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

connect	연결하다	remote	외딴, 먼
route	노선, 경로	attend	참석하다, 다니다
rural	시골의, 농촌의	alternative	대안
depend	의존하다	reliable	믿을 수 있는, 신뢰할 수 있는
affect	영향을 미치다	transport	교통, 운송

Why Bottle Caps Need Their Own Bin

By Sunny · 2026-09-28 · 219 words · L3



페트병 뚜껑을 따로 모으는 이유

Have you ever wondered why some recycling programs ask you to remove the cap before throwing away a plastic bottle? It turns out that caps and bottles are made from different types of plastic.

Most plastic bottles are made from PET plastic, which melts at one temperature. Bottle caps, however, are usually made from a different plastic called polypropylene. Because they melt at different temperatures, they must be processed separately.

A Problem at the Factory

When caps are left on bottles, they can cause problems at recycling facilities. If a cap flies off during processing, it can damage machines or hurt workers. Mixed plastics are also harder to turn into new products.

A Tiny Cap, a Big Challenge

Polypropylene is not recycled very often. In fact, only about one percent of it is currently recycled worldwide. This is partly because there are not many factories that can handle it, and it is easy to contaminate — or spoil — a batch of recyclable material.

Because of this, many recycling programs collect caps separately so they can be sent to the right facility. Some schools and community groups even gather caps as a special project.

Small actions like removing a bottle cap before recycling can make a real difference. When materials are sorted correctly, recycling works much better for everyone.

한글 요약

플라스틱 병과 뚜껑은 서로 다른 종류의 플라스틱인 PET와 폴리프로필렌으로 만들어져 있어, 녹는 온도가 달라 반드시 따로 처리해야 합니다. 폴리프로필렌은 전 세계적으로 약 1퍼센트만 재활용될 정도로 처리가 어렵고 오염 위험도 높습니다. 재활용 전에 병뚜껑을 분리하는 작은 습관이 재활용 효율을 높이는 데 큰 도움이 됩니다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

remove 제거하다, 빼다	contaminate 오염시키다
process 처리하다	melt 녹다
separately 따로, 분리하여	batch 한 묶음, 한 회분
facility 시설	sort 분류하다
damage 손상시키다	material 재료, 물질

스크랩하기 Scrap It!

이름 _____ 날짜 _____ 학교 · 반 _____

1. 이번 호 기사 목록 — 스크랩할 기사에 □ 표시하세요

- ☐ 교육 What Does a Report Card Look Like Without Tests?
 - ☐ 문화 Saving Korea's Disappearing Local Dialects
 - ☐ 경제 Teens Use Apps to Manage Their Allowance
 - ☐ 세계 Electricity Travels Under the Sea
 - ☐ 건강 Should Students Wear Sports Clothes to School?
 - ☐ 기술 Cameras That Recognize Your Face at School
 - ☐ 사회 When the Last Bus Stops Coming
 - ☐ 환경 Why Bottle Caps Need Their Own Bin

2. 스크랩할 기사·제목과 섹션

3. 기사 요약 (3문장)

4. 새로 배운 단어 5개 · 뜻

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5. 내 생각 · 이 기사가 중요한 이유